

August 2026

Dear Beau Lafayette,

I've worked in Orinda long enough to recognize when a home has been done right, and 31 Sandy Court is one of those homes. The Branagh Development pedigree, the .65-acre cul-de-sac lot, the primary suite with its own fireplace, the vineyard out back - these are the details that make a property stand out, and they stood out to me the moment I reviewed the listing. I'm reaching out because the home came off the market without a sale, and I think I understand why.

At \$865 per square foot on a 2005 Branagh build with recent updates, the price sits right in the architectural tier of the Orinda market - a defensible number, but one that demands a very specific buyer to recognize the full picture. Thirty-two days is shorter than most expired listings, but in this price range, 32 days without an accepted offer typically tells you something: the right buyers saw a polished home and didn't fully understand what they were looking at. The vineyard, the cul-de-sac privacy, the Branagh craftsmanship - those aren't details buyers absorb from a photo grid and a bullet list. They need to be experienced visually before a buyer will drive out for a showing.

I've put together a short analysis of the three specific gaps I see between what this home offers and how it was presented to the market - including what a relaunch would need to look and feel like to reach the buyer this home deserves. It's in the pages that follow.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing strategy, please feel free to set this aside - no hard feelings at all. But if you're still figuring out the next step, I'd welcome a short conversation. No pressure, just an honest look at the numbers and a couple of paths worth considering.

With respect,



Ben Olsen

REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates
(925) 255-9727 · brightworkrealty.com
455 Moraga Road, Suite I · Moraga, CA 94556

The Path to Sold:

31 Sandy Ct

Orinda, CA 94563

4.0 Beds · 4 Baths · 3,345 Sq Ft · Orinda

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 31 Sandy Ct

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Branagh-Built Cul-de-Sac Retreat on .65 Acres - and a Listing That Didn't Close the Deal

31 Sandy Court checks the boxes that serious Orinda buyers are actively searching for: a Branagh Development build with soaring ceilings and refined millwork, 3,345 square feet on a .65-acre lot tucked at the end of a three-home cul-de-sac, a recently renovated primary bathroom and updated hardwood floors, a chef's kitchen open to the family room, a private vineyard, a hot tub, and a primary suite with a fireplace. These are not incidental features. They are the exact combination of privacy, quality, and lifestyle that buyers at this price point will pay a premium to find - and rarely do.

The listing history tells a straightforward story: 32 days on market, no sale, withdrawn. At \$865 per square foot, the home sits in the architectural tier of the Orinda benchmark, where the price is supportable but not self-explanatory. Buyers comparing options online needed to understand exactly what the Branagh name means, why a private vineyard and a .65-acre cul-de-sac lot justify that number, and why this home is categorically different from standard updated inventory nearby. The standard listing approach - MLS distribution and a well-written description - isn't designed to answer those questions for buyers before they decide whether to schedule a showing. That's the gap.

\$2,895,000

List Price

\$865/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch for 31 Sandy Court needs to do one thing well: give buyers who have never heard of Branagh Development - and who have never seen a home with a private vineyard and a cul-de-sac lot of this size in Orinda - the visual and narrative depth to understand what they're looking at before they ever set foot inside.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: The Branagh Difference Was Named But Never Shown

The listing description does exactly what it should in words: it calls out soaring ceilings, refined millwork, generous proportions, and the Branagh Development name. But at \$2,895,000, words are a starting point, not a finish line. Buyers in this price range are conducting serious online research before committing to a showing, and they need to see the craftsmanship that justifies the price tag - not read about it. Standard MLS photography captures rooms. It rarely captures the feeling of a space. A Branagh ceiling, the relationship between the kitchen and the family room, the scale of the primary suite with its fireplace - these need to be experienced from the inside out, not inferred from a flat image taken at standard height. The visual gap almost certainly filtered out buyers who would have recognized the value the moment they walked in.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork deploys full Matterport 3D tours on every listing at this price point, so buyers can walk through the home from anywhere before scheduling a showing. Buyers who tour virtually arrive at the property already sold on the space - the showing becomes a confirmation, not a first impression.

Friction #2: The .65-Acre Setting and Vineyard Were a Footnote, Not the Story

A private vineyard, a hot tub with sunset views, entertaining patios, and an expansive turf lawn on .65 acres at the end of a cul-de-sac - this is the lifestyle asset that separates 31 Sandy Court from nearly every other 4-bedroom home in Orinda. But buyers scrolling through listings online at this price range can't feel lot depth from a front elevation shot or understand cul-de-sac privacy from a satellite thumbnail. Without aerial context showing the property's position, the surrounding canopy, the scale of the grounds relative to neighboring homes, the outdoor story remains invisible. Buyers see a backyard. They don't see a retreat. That distinction matters when you're asking them to spend \$2,895,000.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour captures aerial neighborhood context - lot position, tree canopy, the cul-de-sac setting, and the scale of the grounds - in a way no ground photograph can replicate. For a property where the outdoor environment is a primary asset, the Sky Tour isn't a bonus. It's the argument.

Friction #3: The Right Buyers Were Never Actively Found

At \$2,895,000 in mid-2026, the buyer pool for 31 Sandy Court is defined and reachable - but it isn't large, and it isn't passive. These are typically move-up buyers from San Francisco or Oakland, dual-income households with school-age children, buyers who are researching Lamorinda neighborhoods weeks or months before they formally engage an agent. They are on Zillow, on homes.com, and on targeted digital channels. A standard MLS distribution strategy puts the listing in front of buyers who are already searching Orinda. It does very little to reach buyers who are still comparing Lamorinda against other East Bay communities and haven't yet decided where to focus. For a home at this price and with these lifestyle features, that's the buyer who needs to be actively brought to the door.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement puts 31 Sandy Court in front of buyers with premium visibility and routes all inquiries directly back to the listing team - not to unaffiliated agents who may never follow up. Combined with geo-targeted digital campaigns reaching SF and East Bay buyers actively researching the Lamorinda corridor, it's a distribution strategy built for the buyers this home needs, not just the buyers already

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	31 Sandy Ct	Orinda Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$865/sqft	Architectural tier: \$860–\$950/sqft
Lot / Setting	.65 acres, private cul-de-sac of 3 homes	Typical Orinda lot: .25–.40 acres, shared street
Architectural Character	Branagh Development build, 2005, soaring ceilings, refined millwork	Standard updated inventory, tract or spec construction
Premium Features	Private vineyard, hot tub, turf lawn, primary suite w/ fireplace, renovated primary bath, EV charger	Standard 4-bed floor plan, typical backyard
HOA	None	Varies; many Orinda communities \$0–\$300/mo

The verdict: At \$865/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$860-\$950/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$865 per square foot, 31 Sandy Court is priced at the entry point of the Orinda architectural tier - a position the home's Branagh pedigree, lot size, and recent updates genuinely support. The numbers are defensible. The challenge is that buyers comparing at this price need specific evidence - visual, narrative, and data-driven - to understand why \$865 here is not the same as \$865 anywhere else in Orinda. That case was never fully made, and that's what a relaunch needs to correct.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Rebuild the Visual Case for What Branagh and .65 Acres Actually Mean

The most important thing a relaunch can do for 31 Sandy Court is replace the standard photo grid with a full visual story: Matterport 3D interior, Sky Tour aerial showing the cul-de-sac position and lot depth, and cinematic photography that captures the scale of the primary suite, the kitchen-to-family-room connection, and the outdoor entertaining environment at its best. Buyers at \$2,895,000 make decisions based on what they see online before they ever call an agent. Right now, this home's visual presentation doesn't match its actual quality. That's the first thing to fix.

Pillar II - Take the Listing to the Buyers, Not the Other Way Around

The buyer for 31 Sandy Court is probably not sitting on Zillow searching 'Orinda 4-bedroom' today. They are more likely a San Francisco or Oakland family who is six weeks away from deciding to focus their search on Lamorinda - and they haven't been introduced to this home yet. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach those buyers in the window before they've committed to a market, and our off-market private buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com puts the property in front of qualified buyers who have opted in to receive alerts before a home ever hits public portals. Passive distribution didn't close this deal. Active distribution has to.

Pillar III - Lead With the Lifestyle, Then Let the Numbers Follow

The vineyard, the cul-de-sac, the Branagh craftsmanship, the proximity to Highway 24 and top-rated schools - none of these are background details. They are the headline. A relaunch strategy for this home starts with a clear lifestyle narrative built around what Orinda actually offers a family: privacy, community, outdoor living, and a home that's been done right so they don't have to do anything. When buyers understand what they're buying into, the price makes sense on its own. When they don't, even a well-priced home sits.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727 · 455 Moraga Road, Suite I, Moraga, CA 94556